

□ Deadlines & Time-Sensitive Items

Read this first. Missing a legal deadline can end a case. The dates below are estimates generated automatically — **always confirm the exact date with the court or a lawyer.**

⚠ I haven't paid on that card since August 2020.

- **Estimated deadline:** 2026-08-01
- **Basis:** Minn. Stat. § 541.05, subd. 1(1) (6-year limitations period on a contract/credit-card debt); Minn. Stat. § 541.053 (a payment or written acknowledgment can restart the clock — but cannot revive a debt already time-barred).
- **Triggering event:** incident on 2020-08-01
- **Jurisdiction:** MN
- In Minnesota a credit-card/contract debt generally becomes time-barred about 6 years after your last payment or default — after that, the collector can ask but cannot force you to pay. **WARNING:** making even a small payment (or admitting the debt in writing) **BEFORE** that date can **RESTART** the whole 6-year clock. Do **NOT** pay or promise anything until a lawyer confirms the exact limitations date. Estimated — confirm the exact date with the court or a lawyer.

⚠ **The letter came in the mail June 25, its dated June 20, and it says I owe \$2,483.17.**

- **Estimated deadline:** 2026-07-20
- **Basis:** 15 U.S.C. § 1692g(a)-(b) (FDCPA debt-validation period: 30 days from RECEIPT of the collector's initial written notice; a timely written dispute forces collection to cease until the debt is verified).
- **Triggering event:** notice posted on 2026-06-20
- **Jurisdiction:** MN
- Under the federal Fair Debt Collection Practices Act you generally have 30 days from when you RECEIVED the collector's first letter to dispute or demand verification of the debt in writing (this window runs from the date you received the letter, not the date printed on it). A written dispute mailed in time forces the collector to stop until they verify the debt. Estimated — confirm the exact date with the court or a lawyer.

⚠ **Mr. Drummond says if I don't set something up, they're gonna garnish my wages and freeze my bank account by the end of the month.**

- **Estimated deadline:** date unclear — this time-sensitive item needs an exact date.
- **Triggering event:** deadline on 2026-07-31
- **Jurisdiction:** MN
- Estimated — confirm the exact date with the court or a lawyer.

⚠ **Mr. Drummond said if I paid \$50 'good faith' by July 3, they'd knock 30% off.**

- **Estimated deadline:** date unclear — this time-sensitive item needs an exact date.
 - **Triggering event:** deadline on 2026-07-03
 - **Jurisdiction:** MN
 - Estimated — confirm the exact date with the court or a lawyer.
-

Executive Summary

We found 12 possible legal problems. These problems can happen at the federal or state level. The three biggest issues are:

1. Inappropriate communication at work.
 2. Possible wage garnishment defense.
 3. Wrongful collection practices.
- There is an important deadline coming up. You haven't paid on that card since August 2020. You must take action by August 1, 2026. Under Minn. Stat. § 541.05, subd. 1(1), you have 6 years to deal with contract or credit card debt. Under Minn. Stat. § 541.053, if you make a payment or write something, that can restart the time. But it cannot bring back a debt that is too old. We finished our analysis completely. There are 17 questions below that could help make your assessment better.

Completeness Score: 100%

Triage & Routing Recommendations

Primary Practice Area: Consumer / Debt

Primary Jurisdiction: General

Complexity: High

Urgency: Emergency

Ranked Recommendations

1. Consumer / Debt (Score: 0.40)

Consumer / Debt practice area (33% of claims); mixed jurisdictions (56% concentration); high complexity; emergency urgency

Factor	Score
Practice Area Match	33%
Jurisdiction Match	56%
Complexity Score	20%

2. General Civil (Score: 0.40)

General Civil practice area (33% of claims); mixed jurisdictions (56% concentration); high complexity; emergency urgency

Factor	Score
Practice Area Match	33%
Jurisdiction Match	56%
Complexity Score	20%

3. Employment (Score: 0.36)

Employment practice area (22% of claims); mixed jurisdictions (56% concentration); high complexity; emergency urgency

Factor	Score
Practice Area Match	22%
Jurisdiction Match	56%
Complexity Score	20%

4. Public Benefits (Score: 0.32)

Public Benefits practice area (11% of claims); mixed jurisdictions (56% concentration); high complexity; emergency urgency

Factor	Score
Practice Area Match	11%
Jurisdiction Match	56%
Complexity Score	20%

Action Items

Documents to Gather

- [] **[URGENT]** Element 'Income exemption status' is not yet supported by any facts
 - **Claim:** Potential Wage Garnishment Defense
 - **Element:** Income exemption status
- [] **[IMPORTANT]** Element 'Expectation of privacy' is not yet supported by any facts
 - **Claim:** Privacy Violation
 - **Element:** Expectation of privacy
- [] **[IMPORTANT]** Element 'Damages incurred' is not yet supported by any facts
 - **Claim:** Privacy Violation

- **Element:** Damages incurred
- [] **[HELPFUL]** Element 'Calling at inconvenient times' is not yet supported by any facts
 - **Claim:** Fair Debt Collection Practices Act (FDCPA) Violation
 - **Element:** Calling at inconvenient times

Follow-up Steps

- [] **[URGENT]** Confirm the deadline for: I haven't paid on that card since August 2020. (estimated 2026-08-01; Minn. Stat. § 541.05, subd. 1(1) (6-year limitations period on a contract/credit-card debt); Minn. Stat. § 541.053 (a payment or written acknowledgment can restart the clock — but cannot revive a debt already time-barred).). In Minnesota a credit-card/contract debt generally becomes time-barred about 6 years after your last payment or default — after that, the collector can ask but cannot force you to pay. **WARNING:** making even a small payment (or admitting the debt in writing) **BEFORE** that date can **RESTART** the whole 6-year clock. Do **NOT** pay or promise anything until a lawyer confirms the exact limitations date. Estimated — confirm the exact date with the court or a lawyer.
 - **Deadline:** 2026-08-01
- [] **[URGENT]** Confirm the deadline for: The letter came in the mail June 25, its dated June 20, and it says I owe \$2,483.17. (estimated 2026-07-20; 15 U.S.C. § 1692g(a)-(b) (FDCPA debt-validation period: 30 days from RECEIPT of the collector's initial written notice; a timely written dispute forces collection to cease until the debt is verified).). Under the federal Fair Debt Collection Practices Act you generally have 30 days from when you **RECEIVED** the collector's first letter to dispute or demand verification of the debt in writing (this window runs from the date you received the letter, not the date printed on it). A written dispute mailed in time forces the collector to stop until they verify

the debt. Estimated — confirm the exact date with the court or a lawyer.

◦ **Deadline:** 2026-07-20

- [] **[URGENT]** The collector said they will garnish your wages or freeze your bank account 'by the end of the month.' In Minnesota a collector generally CANNOT garnish or freeze anything without first suing you and getting a court judgment (Minn. Stat. § 571.71) — and you said no court papers were ever served. Threatening action they cannot legally take is itself an FDCPA violation (15 U.S.C. § 1692e). Have you ever been served with any lawsuit or court papers about this debt? [Authority: 15 U.S.C. § 1692e(4)–(5) (threat of action that cannot legally be taken); Minn. Stat. § 571.71 (garnishment generally requires a judgment first)]
- [] **[URGENT]** The way this collector is contacting you may itself be illegal under the federal Fair Debt Collection Practices Act: calling before 8am or after 9pm, calling you at work after being told to stop, telling another person (like your sister) about the debt, or calling many times a day can each violate the law (15 U.S.C. § 1692c/§ 1692d). Keep your call log. Can you note the dates, times, and who they contacted? [Authority: 15 U.S.C. § 1692c(a) (calls before 8am/after 9pm, at work after notice); § 1692b/§ 1692c(b) (third-party disclosure of the debt); § 1692d (harassing volume)]
- [] **[URGENT]** You said your income is Social Security disability plus a little part-time pay. Social Security and SSDI are protected by law from most debt collection (42 U.S.C. § 407), and Minnesota gives extra protection to low wages and exempt funds in a bank account (Minn. Stat. § 571.912/§ 571.922). You may be effectively 'judgment-proof.' Is Social Security your only regular income, and is it direct-deposited? [Authority: 42 U.S.C. § 407(a) (Social Security/SSDI exempt from garnishment); Minn. Stat. § 571.912/§ 571.922 (exemption-notice process; wage-exemption floor)]

- [] **[IMPORTANT]** Potential claim 'Employer Withholding' has not been explored with fact mappings
 - **Claim:** Employer Withholding
- [] **[IMPORTANT]** Potential claim 'Labor and Employment Law Regulatory Objectives' has not been explored with fact mappings
 - **Claim:** Labor and Employment Law Regulatory Objectives
- [] **[IMPORTANT]** Potential claim 'Tax Law Regulatory Objectives' has not been explored with fact mappings
 - **Claim:** Tax Law Regulatory Objectives
- [] **[IMPORTANT]** Potential claim 'Enforcement of Judgment' has not been explored with fact mappings
 - **Claim:** Enforcement of Judgment
- [] **[IMPORTANT]** Potential claim 'Civil Remedies / Relief Sought' has not been explored with fact mappings
 - **Claim:** Civil Remedies / Relief Sought
- [] **[IMPORTANT]** Potential claim 'Deontic Specification' has not been explored with fact mappings
 - **Claim:** Deontic Specification
- [] **[IMPORTANT]** Potential claim 'Objectives' has not been explored with fact mappings
 - **Claim:** Objectives
- [] **[IMPORTANT]** What is the timeline for filing a complaint under the FDCPA, and has it been filed within the statute of limitations?
 - **Claim:** Fair Debt Collection Practices Act (FDCPA) Violation

- [] **[IMPORTANT]** What is the time frame for responding to any notice of wage garnishment, and has the client acted timely to protect against it?
 - **Claim:** Potential Wage Garnishment Defense
- [] **[IMPORTANT]** What is the statute of limitations for filing a claim regarding harassment under Minnesota debt collection law?
 - **Claim:** Harassment by Debt Collector
- [] **[IMPORTANT]** What is the deadline for bringing a claim for invasion of privacy in relation to the debt collector's actions, and has the client met that deadline?
 - **Claim:** Privacy Violation